

You don't always realize how bright your own fire burns until you get close enough to feel its heat.

It's strange, isn't it? How we warn ourselves not to fly too high, not to want too much, not to risk the fall, yet some part of us still aches for the sky.

We talk about Icarus like he was foolish for reaching upward, but we forget the part where he learned to trust his wings. We forget that before the fall, there was flight.

Before the cautionary tale, there was courage.

We spend so much time trying to avoid mistakes that we forget mistakes are proof that we dared.

We tell others to chase their dreams, but

when our own hearts pull us toward something bigger, we call it unrealistic. We comfort friends when they stumble, but when we slip, we act like we should've known better.

We forgive others for wanting more, but we punish ourselves for the same hunger.

But here's the truth you lose sight of when fear gets loud:

Reaching isn't the problem.

Forgetting your limits isn't the problem.

The real danger is believing you're meant to stay small.

Every time you try again after disappointment.

Every time you let yourself hope after being hurt.

Every time you choose possibility over certainty — that's bravery. Not the

reckless kind. The intentional kind. The kind that says, “Even if I fall, I’ll rise differently.”

You don’t have to dim your ambition to stay safe.

You don’t have to clip your own wings to avoid the sun.

You don’t have to pretend you’re content on the ground when something in you was built for altitude.

You’re allowed to want more.

You’re allowed to learn through trial and error.

You’re allowed to fly imperfectly.

Because growth isn’t about never falling — it’s about learning how to navigate the air.

Some days you’ll soar.

Some days you'll drift.

Some days you'll come back down to
rebuild what melted.

But even those days matter. Even those
days shape you.

So give yourself permission to rise.

Honor the part of you that longs for the
horizon.

Celebrate the courage it takes to lift off at
all.

You're becoming braver, wiser, steadier
with every attempt.

And even if you're still finding your
altitude, you're not lost.

You're learning the sky one flight at a
time.